

incumbency vote rather than an endorsement of Banerjee or her party. The Marxists have been pickled in their own sauce and the complacency that had set in a party which has had an uninterrupted run of power for over three decades has cost it dear. The wavering leadership of Karat & Co, the empty rhetoric of Sitaram Yechury, and Jyoti Basu's demise have contributed to the party's poor show in the civic polls.

C.V. ARAVIND,

via www.indiatoday.in

Let the Son Rise

It is not fair on the part of the Congress High Command to slam the brakes on Jaganmohan Reddy's consolation tour ("The Prodigal Son", June 14). When he toured west Godavari and Khammam districts, thousands of people turned up to hear him. He was stopped from touring further due to the Telangana threat. But there is no reason to stop him now. The Congress' state and central wings do not want Reddy to emerge as another leader in Andhra Pradesh.

KAPPAGANTU MURTHY,
Secunderabad

Tongue Tied

Kaveri Bamzai's column on the prime minister was a refreshing piece of plain-speaking ("Mister Mum", June 14). She diagnosed our ailment correctly—"we

have such low expectations." At the much-awaited press conference, the prime minister did not answer any of the questions with conviction or confidence. Some media reviews were kind, saying that he had the constraints of leading a coalition government. Coalitions are going to be the future norm. They cannot be an excuse for playing with the nation's future.

SOM SHARMA, *Gurgaon*

Leadership Crisis

The RSS should have chosen a leader with national

his head. However, it has been only six months and he has a long way to go. Let him come out of the Marathi shell and act as a national figure during the rest of his tenure and the BJP could rise again.

R. THIRUNARAYANAN,

via www.indiatoday.in

State of Despair

Thanks to a fractured assembly election verdict, Jharkhand has to live with failed governments whose terms have been numbered ("The Last Waltz", June 14). The latest casualty is Shibu Soren

MANDAR DEODHAR/ www.indiatodayimages.com



“Too much exposure to TV shows is robbing children of their innocence ("Parent Trap", June 7). From great public attention to obscurity at a young age could be a traumatic experience.”

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

level experience to head the BJP ("Slippery Slope", June 7). Nitin Gadkari should have been given the responsibilities of vice-president and then general secretary before being crowned president. It is natural that the crown in question is too heavy for

who has often resorted to gimmicks to be at the helm of affairs in the state. The time has come to dump such opportunists who are doing more harm than good to the state by focusing only on personal gain.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

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30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

SEPTEMBER 1-15, 1980

Politics of Insecurity

In the end, it turned out to be a bloody celebration for everybody. What started as a day of prayer and feasting in a Moradabad mosque became, in a matter of minutes, an inflamed riot, a murderous stampede, a police atrocity. In a matter of hours, the violence was spreading by some remote-control mechanism, to small towns and large cities all over north India: from Aligarh to Allahabad, Srinagar to Old Delhi, a familiar but raw tension gripped Muslim neighbourhoods, as truckloads of policemen set up curfew curtains to control the shock waves of rumour, arson, conspiracy and murder. Pig or no pig—there was, at the end of it all, a chilling sense of déjà vu in the precedents to the problem. The geography hadn't changed at all, but history was repeating itself. Over a span of approximately three centuries, the colourings and conditions may have changed, the crux of the matter hasn't. *by Suman*

Dubey, Bhabani Sen Gupta,

Prabhu Chawla and Sunil Sethi



A MADARSA IN DELHI